



THE BOUNDLESS BRIEF · FREE RESOURCE

Grant Readiness: A 10-Point Checklist

Before you spend hours on an application, make sure you are actually ready. Run these ten checks first. If you can't check at least eight, close those gaps or find a better-fit grant.

- ☐ **Eligibility.** You clearly meet every requirement, organization type, location, and size.
- ☐ **Mission fit.** The funder's stated priorities genuinely match your work, not a stretch.
- ☐ **A clear, evidenced need.** You can state the problem with data, not just passion.
- ☐ **A defined program.** Specific activities, a timeline, and exactly who it serves.
- ☐ **Measurable outcomes.** You can show impact with numbers and evidence, not just intentions.
- ☐ **A realistic budget.** Costs are itemized and tied directly to the work.
- ☐ **A sustainability plan.** You can explain what happens after the grant ends.
- ☐ **Organizational capacity.** You can actually deliver what you promise, on time.
- ☐ **Documents ready.** Financials, letters of support, and registrations are in hand.
- ☐ **Deadline & format locked.** You know the exact due date, any LOI, and the submission rules.

Tip: fit beats effort. A well-matched grant you're ready for beats a long-shot you're not.